

LIGHT OF FAITH

نور الإيمان

The Foundations of
Islamic Belief

Aqāid

A journey through the six pillars of faith —
understanding what Muslims believe, why
they believe it, and how belief brings peace to
life.

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Preface

Faith is the foundation of every meaningful life. Just as a building stands firm only when its base is strong, the structure of a believer's life depends upon the strength and clarity of their faith — their **Aqāid (beliefs)**. This booklet has been written with simplicity and sincerity, to help readers understand the **core beliefs of Islam** as taught by the Qur'an and Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him). It is especially prepared for:

- **New Muslims**, who wish to build a solid understanding of what they believe and why.
- **Non-Muslims**, who want to learn what Islam truly teaches about God, creation, and human purpose.
- **Born Muslims**, who seek to refresh their faith and understand its logic and harmony.

Our aim is not to argue, but to **clarify** — to show that Islamic beliefs are not abstract dogmas, but **rational, spiritual truths** that appeal to both the heart and the mind.

Each chapter explores one of the **six fundamental beliefs of Islam**:

1. The Oneness of God (Tawḥīd)
2. Belief in Angels (Malā'ikah)
3. Belief in Divine Books (Kutub)
4. Belief in Prophets (Nubuwwah)
5. Belief in the Last Day (Ākhirah)
6. Belief in Divine Decree (Qadar)

Every concept is explained in plain English, supported by simple logic and relatable examples. The purpose is to make faith **understandable, livable, and deeply personal**. May this small effort be a means of enlightenment for those seeking truth, comfort for those seeking peace, and strength for those striving to live with purpose.

— **Dr. Munib Siddiqui**

Introduction

What Are Aqāid?

The word *Aqāid* (singular: *Aqāidah*) comes from the Arabic root ‘*aqada*, meaning “to tie firmly.” Just as a knot holds two things together securely, **Aqāid are the firm beliefs that tie a person’s heart to truth.**

In Islam, Aqāid form the **first and most essential pillar** of the religion. Before prayer, charity, fasting, or pilgrimage, one must first have the right belief — for belief gives meaning to all actions.

Why Understanding Aqāid Matters

Faith is more than just saying “I believe.”

True faith (*īmān*) is **knowing, understanding, and trusting** what we believe.

Without understanding, faith can become weak or confused. But when belief is based on clear understanding, it gives:

- **Purpose:** Knowing why we exist and what we are meant to do.
- **Peace:** Trusting that life has meaning, even when times are difficult.
- **Direction:** Knowing what is right and wrong through divine guidance.
- **Unity:** Sharing a clear foundation of faith that connects us to all believers.

The Qur’an calls believers to “*reflect, reason, and understand*” — because Islam encourages thinking, not blind following.

How to Study Aqāid

This booklet is designed for personal reflection and study circles. To benefit most, readers are encouraged to:

1. **Read slowly and thoughtfully:** Each chapter builds on the previous one.
2. **Reflect deeply:** Try to connect the belief with your personal experience of life and faith.
3. **Discuss and share:** Explaining a concept to others strengthens understanding.
4. **Link belief with practice:** Aqāid are not only theories — they shape our prayers, character, and way of life.

The Journey of Faith

Faith in Islam is not blind submission — it is a **journey of the mind and heart**.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) taught that “*Faith has seventy branches*”, meaning it grows and deepens over time.

Understanding the **six pillars of belief** is the first step in that journey.

As you read, keep in mind: Islam invites you not only to **believe**, but to **know** — to see how belief in God, angels, revelation, prophets, the afterlife, and destiny brings harmony to the world and meaning to the soul.

May this journey of learning strengthen your faith, enlighten your heart, and bring you closer to the Creator who made you with love and purpose.

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Chapter 1 — the Oneness of God (Tawḥīd)

What we mean by “Oneness of God”

When Muslims say Tawḥīd (the Oneness of God), we mean three basic things:

1. There is one ultimate Creator and Sustainer of everything that exists.
2. Only God deserves worship — our ultimate loyalty and spiritual practice are directed to Him alone.
3. God’s nature, names, and attributes are unique and unlike anything created.

Put simply: one source of existence, one authority over right and wrong, and one final point of meaning for life.

Why Oneness matters

➤ Cause and effect

Everything that exists had a cause (even if it’s a natural process). Either:

- Causes go back forever (an infinite chain) — but an actual infinite regress of causes doesn’t explain why anything exists now; it only postpones the question;
- Or there is a first cause — something that does not need a cause.

Tawḥīd says that first cause is God: a being whose existence is necessary, not caused. This explains why the universe exists rather than nothing.

➤ **Design and order**

The world shows patterns, regularities, and systems (from atoms to ecosystems to human consciousness). When we see reliable order in a watch or a computer, we infer a maker. The same basic reasoning can apply to the universe at large: order points toward an origin that can sustain order.

➤ **Moral grounding**

If objective moral values (things that are right or wrong beyond cultural opinion) exist, they need a grounding. Tawḥīd offers a single moral source — God — who defines deep moral truths that are not just social habits.

Three aspects of Tawḥīd (explained simply)

1. Lordship (Rubūbiyah) — God as Creator, Provider, and Controller.
Example: The sun, seasons, and food cycles continue without human permission; someone who plans, sustains and maintains such order is called a Lord or Sustainer.
2. Worship (Ulūhiyah) — God is the one we ultimately turn to for meaning, prayer, and devotion.
Example: People pray to many things in life — money, status, relationships — but Islam says ultimate trust and devotion should be directed only to the Creator.
3. Names & Attributes (Asmā' wa Sifāt) — God's qualities (merciful, just, knowing) are real but are not identical to created qualities.
Example: A doctor is merciful and knowledgeable; those qualities in the doctor are limited. God's mercy is unlimited and not comparable to human mercy.

How this differs from other ideas

- Monotheism vs. polytheism: Tawḥīd rejects multiple competing creators or ultimate powers. If more than one

ultimate were true, their wills could conflict; the world wouldn't run smoothly.

- Monotheism vs. pantheism: Tawḥīd does not say God equals the world (God $\neq$ universe). God is greater than His creation and relates to it, while also being distinct.
- Monotheism vs. deism: Some believe God set the world going then left it. Tawḥīd teaches God continues to sustain and care for creation.

Objections and simple responses

Objection: “If God is good and all-powerful, why is there suffering?”

Short reply:

- Free will and natural laws can produce suffering without negating the presence of a wise Creator.
- Many things with great power (parents, doctors) sometimes permit risk to allow higher goods (freedom, learning, trust).
- Tawḥīd gives a framework: life is meaningful, actions matter, and ultimate justice is not denied — accountability is part of the picture.

Objection: “Science explains the universe; we don't need God.”

Short reply:

- Science explains how processes occur (mechanisms). The question of why there is something rather than nothing, or why the laws are such that life and mind are possible, is philosophical and metaphysical — it sits alongside science, not replaced by it.
- Many scientists are people of faith who see science and belief as answering different kinds of questions.

Objection: “Why only one God? Many religions exist.”

Short reply:

- Tawḥīd focuses on the logical coherence of an ultimate source. Different religions reflect different cultural responses to the same basic human questions. Tawḥīd asks, “What is the simplest, most coherent answer to the fact of existence, order, and moral law?” For Muslims, the answer is one Creator.

Everyday examples that make Tawḥīd relatable

Example 1 — Trusting a doctor vs. ultimate trust

You may trust a doctor to treat your illness. That trust is useful, limited, and conditional. Tawḥīd says we can and should trust God in a deeper, ultimate sense — not replacing medical care, but recognizing a final reliance beyond all human help.

Example 2 — Laws and lawmakers

A nation functions because people agree to a law and accept a government. If every citizen made a different law, society would collapse. Tawḥīd is like recognizing one absolute Lawgiver whose rules create the moral and practical conditions for human flourishing.

Example 3 — The watch and the watchmaker (everyday design argument)

A functioning machine implies a maker. A car’s engine shows design. The universe’s fine-tuning and complex systems can be compared to engineered systems: they suggest an intelligence capable of setting up such systems.

What Oneness of God changes in life (practical effects)

- Purpose: Life becomes meaningful — a test, a journey toward accountability.
- Unity: All humans are accountable to the same ultimate standard; spiritual equality is emphasized.
- Morality: Ethical choices are rooted in something beyond mere preference.
- Hope: God's attributes (merciful, forgiving) provide a basis for repentance and change.
- Responsibility: If one believes a single God watches and judges, actions gain lasting weight.

A gentle invitation, not a demand

Tawḥīd is intended to be considered thoughtfully. If you are skeptical, try this small experiment: for a week, reflect on three questions each evening:

1. Where did this day's existence, order, and opportunities come from?
2. What ultimate standard guided my choices?
3. Does the idea of a single, just, merciful source make more sense of life than no source at all?

Compare how the idea fits with your experience.

Short summary

- Tawḥīd says there is one necessary, uncaused, intelligent, and moral Creator.
- It answers questions about why anything exists, why the world is ordered, and where moral authority comes from.
- It is compatible with reason and with everyday experiences of design, trust, and moral obligation.
- For Muslims, believing in God's Oneness shapes life, law, and personal conduct.

Chapter 2 — Belief in the Angels (al-Malā'ikah)

What Muslims mean by “Angels”

In Islam, angels are not imagined as winged fairies or mythological spirits.

They are real, conscious creations of God, made from *light* (nūr), who serve specific purposes in the running of the universe.

They are not gods, nor are they partners with God.

They do not share His divinity — they simply carry out His commands with perfect obedience and without sin.

Muslims believe in angels because they are mentioned throughout the Qur'an and were described clearly by the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him).

Why belief in angels matters

Belief in angels helps people understand that:

1. The universe is not random or empty — it operates under divine order.
2. Every action has accountability, because angels record what we do.
3. We are never alone — spiritual beings accompany and help creation according to God's will.

It bridges the seen and unseen — showing that material life is only part of the story.

What angels do (in simple terms)

The Qur'an describes many roles for angels.

Here are some main ones, explained with easy examples:

Angel	Responsibility	Everyday Analogy
Jibrīl (Gabriel)	Brought revelation to prophets (including the Qur'an to Muhammad)	Like a perfectly secure messenger delivering truth exactly as received, never altering the message.
Mikā'il (Michael)	Controls rain, vegetation, and natural sustenance	Like a manager who distributes resources fairly across the earth — but without personal will; he only follows God's command.
Isrāfīl	Will blow the trumpet to announce the end of the world and the Day of Resurrection	Think of it as the final signal for humanity's accountability.
Malak al-Mawt (Angel of Death)	Takes the soul at the time of death	Not a grim reaper by choice, but a servant who gently fulfills God's will at life's appointed end.
Kirāman Kātibīn	Record all human deeds — one on the right for good, one on the left for wrong	Like an incorruptible recording system — invisible, but completely accurate.
Guardian Angels	Protect people as God wills	A spiritual security system; we're protected in ways we often never notice.

Angels are not supernatural “rivals” to God

In some mythologies, angels or spirits fight against God or have their own power.

In Islam, this idea does not exist.

Angels:

- Do not eat, sleep, or reproduce.
- Have no ego, emotion, or desire.

- Cannot disobey God.
- Are not male or female.
They are *pure instruments of divine will*.

This helps maintain the purity of monotheism — everything in the universe obeys one Creator.

How belief in angels makes sense (a logical explanation)

For someone who believes only in the physical, angels may sound unreal.

But think about this:

- We already accept the existence of forces we cannot see — gravity, radio waves, or thoughts in a human brain.
- You cannot see Wi-Fi, yet your phone connects to it and responds instantly.
- You cannot see electricity, but you see its effects.

In the same way, angels are non-physical forces with intelligence and consciousness, created by God to serve His purposes.

So the belief in angels is not anti-reason — it simply admits that not all reality is visible to human eyes.

Angels and human life — a continuous link

From birth to death, angels interact with human life in unseen ways:

- At birth: An angel records the child's sustenance, lifespan, deeds, and ultimate destiny.
- During life: Angels guard and record actions.
- At death: Angels comfort the believers and separate the soul from the body.
- After death: Angels question the soul in the grave — about belief and deeds.
- On Judgment Day: Angels will witness human actions before God's justice.

The difference between angels, humans, and jinn

Creation	Made from	Has free will?	Visible?	Can sin?
Angels	Light	No	No	No
Humans	Clay (matter)	Yes	Yes	Yes
Jinn	Smokeless fire	Yes	Usually no	Yes

So, humans are unique because they can choose between good and evil — angels cannot.

This makes moral responsibility meaningful.

Why this belief helps daily life

Belief in angels changes how a Muslim lives:

1. Accountability: If I know my actions are being recorded, I think twice before doing harm.
2. Comfort: When I'm alone, I'm not truly alone — there are forces of good around me.
3. Optimism: Angels constantly glorify God; remembering them keeps life positive and hopeful.
4. Protection: Many people can recall moments when they narrowly escaped danger — Muslims believe such moments can be the work of guardian angels, by God's command.

A real-life way to understand this belief

Imagine a big company with a CEO who manages everything.

The CEO doesn't personally carry out every small task — he assigns trusted assistants.

Each employee follows orders exactly and keeps records of their work.

The CEO knows what's happening, but the assistants are part of His organized system.

In the same way, angels are not divine beings but the “executive agents” of God’s will.

They keep the world in order — with no errors, no rebellion, and no fatigue.

What angels teach us about ourselves

Believing in angels encourages humans to be:

- Pure in motive (since angels have no ego).
- Obedient to truth (since angels never disobey).
- Loyal to goodness (since angels work for the wellbeing of all creation).

The Qur’an describes angels as loving those who do good, praying for them, and bringing peace to hearts.

They remind us that doing good connects us to the unseen harmony of the universe.

Summary

- Angels are real, created from light, and serve God’s purposes.
- They carry out divine commands, guide prophets, protect people, and record deeds.
- They help keep moral and cosmic order.
- Believing in angels strengthens faith in accountability, purpose, and unseen reality.
- Angels symbolize purity, obedience, and peace — qualities every person can aspire to.

Chapter 3 — Belief in the Divine Books (al-Kutub)

What Muslims mean by “Divine Books”

In Islam, belief in Divine Books means acknowledging that Allah revealed specific scriptures to guide humanity. These books are not myths or legends; they are real, divinely-inspired guidance sent to help humans understand how to live rightly, ethically, and spiritually.

Muslims believe in all revealed books mentioned in the Qur'an, and the most important of these include:

1. Taurah (Torah) — revealed to Prophet Moses (Musa, peace be upon him)
2. Zabur (Psalms) — revealed to Prophet David (Dawud, peace be upon him)
3. Injeel (Gospel) — revealed to Prophet Jesus (Isa, peace be upon him)
4. Qur'an — revealed to Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him), the final and complete revelation

These books are messages from Allah, meant to guide humans toward worshiping Him alone and living morally upright lives.

Why belief in Divine Books matters

Belief in the revealed books helps people understand that:

1. Human guidance is not random — life has divine instructions.
2. Truth has been consistently sent — Allah has always sent guidance to humanity.
3. Our actions have a framework — there are moral and spiritual laws to follow.
4. Revelations connect the past and present — the Qur'an confirms the truth in previous scriptures and completes the guidance.

It links humans to the unseen reality of God's wisdom, showing that we are not left to navigate life without guidance.

What the Divine Books do (in simple terms)

Book	Prophet	Purpose	Everyday Analogy
Taurah (Torah)	Musa (Moses)	Laws, guidance for Israelites	Like a rulebook for a community to live harmoniously
Zabur (Psalms)	Dawud (David)	Songs, prayers, guidance on worship	A spiritual playlist teaching gratitude and patience
Injeel (Gospel)	Isa (Jesus)	Teachings on morality, compassion	Like a handbook on ethical leadership and caring for others
Qur'an	Muhammad	Complete guidance for all humanity	A universal guidebook covering spiritual, moral, and practical life

Divine Books are not physical “magic”

Some people imagine divine books as magical objects. In Islam, this is not the case.

- They are words of God delivered to humans through prophets.
- They are meant to educate, guide, and correct behavior, not perform miracles on their own.
- Previous books were revealed to specific nations, while the Qur'an is universal, meant for all humanity.

How belief in Divine Books makes sense (logical explanation)

For someone skeptical of scriptures, consider this:

- Societies operate best when there are clear rules and guidance. Laws, medical guidelines, and educational curricula all help people avoid harm.

- Divine books are like the ultimate instruction manuals — written by the Creator of life, containing knowledge no human could invent perfectly.
- Even if humans change or misinterpret earlier books, the Qur'an remains perfectly preserved, showing Allah's care for guidance.

Divine Books and human life — a continuous link

- Moral guidance: Books teach right and wrong.
- Spiritual development: They explain the purpose of worship and ethical behavior.
- Societal laws: Earlier scriptures guided communities in social justice, ethics, and fairness.
- Final guidance: The Qur'an provides complete rules and advice for every aspect of life, applicable to all times and places.

The difference between human books and Divine Books

Aspect	Human books	Divine Books
Source	Human effort	Revelation from Allah
Accuracy	Can be flawed	Perfect in original message
Purpose	Knowledge, entertainment, instruction	Guidance for salvation and righteous living
Preservation	Can be lost or altered	Qur'an preserved completely

Why this belief helps daily life

1. Clarity: Knowing there is divine guidance helps humans navigate moral and ethical dilemmas.
2. Accountability: Books show that life has rules set by God, so our actions matter.
3. Hope: Guidance assures us that solutions for life's problems exist.

4. Connection to God: Following revealed guidance strengthens our relationship with Allah.

A real-life way to understand this belief

Imagine a company producing complex technology. They release instruction manuals for users worldwide. The manual explains every detail clearly — those who follow it succeed, those who ignore it struggle.

- Early manuals (Taurah, Zabur, Injeel) were for specific devices (communities).
- The final manual (Qur'an) is universal, covering all users (humanity).

Following the manual ensures success and avoids unnecessary mistakes.

What Divine Books teach us about ourselves

- Humans need guidance beyond instinct — divine books fulfill this need.
- Life is meaningful — actions matter and are part of a bigger plan.
- Learning, reflecting, and following guidance is a form of worship.
- Divine guidance connects humans to a universal moral and spiritual order.

Summary

- Divine Books are revelations from Allah, delivered through prophets.
- They provide moral, spiritual, and practical guidance for humanity.
- Belief in them reinforces accountability, purpose, and respect for truth.

- The Qur'an is the final and complete revelation, universal for all people.
- Belief in divine books strengthens faith, ethics, and spiritual awareness.

Chapter 4 — Belief in the Prophets (Nubuwwah)

What Muslims mean by “Prophets”

In Islam, prophets (Nabi) are chosen human beings sent by Allah to guide humanity. They are not divine, nor are they worshiped. Their role is to deliver Allah’s message, teach moral and ethical behavior, and exemplify the proper way to live.

Prophets are sent to remind people of God’s guidance, warn against wrongdoing, and encourage righteousness. Islam teaches that all prophets shared the same core message: worship Allah alone and live justly.

Why belief in prophets matters

Believing in prophets helps people understand that:

- 1. Guidance comes from God: Humans alone cannot always determine perfect moral guidance.
- 2. Life has purpose: Prophets teach the meaning of existence and how to fulfill it.
- 3. History has lessons: Stories of prophets show consequences of actions — both good and bad.
- 4. Connection to Allah: Prophets are the bridge between human beings and divine guidance.

What prophets do (in simple terms)

Prophet	Key Role	Everyday Analogy
Adam (peace be upon him)	First human, taught basic obedience	Like a teacher who shows the first steps of life
Nuh (Noah)	Warned people against corruption, saved believers	A community leader who saves those following rules from disaster

Musa (Moses)	Delivered the Torah, guided Israelites	Like a mentor giving detailed instructions for a society
Dawud (David)	Provided moral and spiritual guidance through Psalms	Like a counselor teaching justice and gratitude
Isa (Jesus)	Taught compassion, mercy, and worship	Like a healer teaching care and forgiveness
Muhammad (peace be upon him)	Final prophet, brought Qur'an, universal guidance	Like a CEO giving the ultimate instruction manual for humanity

Prophets are human, not divine

- They eat, sleep, feel pain, and experience life like any human.
- They make decisions based on Allah's guidance, but they never sin in conveying the message.
- They are examples of moral and ethical excellence.

Believing they are human ensures monotheism remains intact — worship is for Allah alone, not His messengers.

How belief in prophets makes sense (logical explanation)

- Imagine a city without law enforcement or teachers — chaos would prevail. Humans need guidance and reminders to live well.
- Prophets are like guides or mentors appointed by God to teach humanity what is right and wrong.
- Just as a company sends experts to train employees for success, Allah sends prophets to teach humanity how to succeed in life and the Hereafter.

Prophets and human life — a continuous link

- Teachings: Provide moral and ethical instructions.
- Warnings: Show consequences of ignoring divine guidance.

- Examples: Serve as role models in faith, patience, and integrity.
- Final guidance: Muhammad (peace be upon him) delivers universal guidance through the Qur'an, applicable for all times.

The difference between prophets and ordinary humans

Aspect	Ordinary Human	Prophet
Guidance	Learns from experience	Receives direct divine guidance
Sin	Yes	Protected from major sin in delivering message
Role	Lives personal life	Guides entire communities
Example	Imperfect	Exemplary moral and ethical conduct

Why this belief helps daily life

1. Moral clarity: Prophets show the right path through example and teaching.
2. Hope and inspiration: Stories of prophets overcoming hardships inspire resilience.
3. Accountability: Knowing guidance is from Allah encourages obedience.
4. Connection to tradition: Following prophets links humans to a universal moral order.

A real-life way to understand this belief

Think of prophets as trusted guides or teachers in a complex city:

- They show where the safe paths are.
- Warn against dangerous areas.
- Provide tools and instructions for navigating life successfully.
- Their instructions are based on knowledge you could never fully acquire on your own.

Following their guidance ensures success, just like following an expert mentor ensures you avoid mistakes in real life.

What prophets teach us about ourselves

- Humans are capable of learning, obeying guidance, and improving morally.
- Life is meaningful when aligned with divine guidance.
- Observing the behavior of prophets encourages self-discipline, honesty, patience, and compassion.

Summary

- Prophets are human messengers chosen by Allah to guide humanity.
- They teach, warn, and exemplify moral and ethical conduct.
- Belief in prophets strengthens faith, accountability, and understanding of God's will.
- Muhammad (peace be upon him) is the final prophet, bringing guidance for all humanity through the Qur'an.

Chapter 5 — Belief in the Last Day (Akhirah)

What Muslims mean by “the Last Day”

In Islam, the Last Day (also called the Day of Judgment) is the day when all humans will be resurrected and held accountable for their actions. Life on earth is temporary, but the Hereafter is eternal. Belief in the Last Day teaches that life has purpose, responsibility, and consequences beyond what we see.

The Qur'an frequently reminds believers that this life is a preparation for the life to come.

Why belief in the Last Day matters

Belief in the Last Day helps people understand that:

1. Life is not random: Every action matters, even if it seems unnoticed.
2. Justice will be served: Wrongdoers will be held accountable, and the oppressed will receive their due.
3. Rewards exist: Good deeds, faith, and patience are not wasted; they will be rewarded.
4. Purpose is reinforced: Life is meaningful when viewed as preparation for eternity.

It emphasizes the moral and spiritual dimension of existence, showing that unseen consequences are real.

What happens on the Last Day (in simple terms)

The reality of the Last Day is not visible

- Humans tend to focus on what they can see: money, power, health.
- The Last Day reminds us that there is a larger reality beyond our senses.

- Just as gravity is invisible yet affects everything, the spiritual reality of accountability is unseen but very real.

Last Day and human life — a continuous link

- Daily morality: Knowing every action is recorded encourages ethical behavior.
- Patience in hardship: Life's difficulties are temporary; ultimate justice is in the Hereafter.
- Spiritual growth: Striving for good deeds becomes meaningful with the promise of reward.
- Deterrence from evil: Fear of accountability discourages harm to others and oneself.

The difference between worldly life and the Hereafter

Why this belief helps daily life

1. Responsibility: Every choice has significance; nothing is trivial.
2. Hope: Good deeds, even unnoticed, are rewarded.
3. Moral compass: Encourages honesty, kindness, and patience.
4. Perspective: Life's hardships are temporary; ultimate justice is divine.

A real-life way to understand this belief

Imagine a school exam with an ultimate final grade:

- Daily homework and class tests represent our deeds in life.
- The final exam is the Last Day — all knowledge and effort are reviewed.
- The grade is fair and reflects everything you did — nothing is ignored.
- Preparing for the final exam gives purpose to everyday studying; similarly, belief in the Last Day gives purpose to daily life.

What the Last Day teaches us about ourselves

- Humans are accountable for their choices and actions.
- Life is meaningful and purposeful.
- Patience, morality, and effort have eternal significance.
- We are not alone in navigating life — ultimate justice comes from Allah.

Summary

- The Last Day is when all humans are resurrected and judged.
- Actions, faith, and intentions are evaluated fairly.
- Belief in the Last Day encourages moral living, hope, patience, and accountability.
- Paradise and Hell are real consequences, reflecting ultimate justice.
- This belief connects human life to a larger, eternal reality.

Chapter 6 — Belief in Qadar (Divine Decree / Predestination)

What Muslims mean by “Qadar”

In Islam, Qadar means that everything that happens in the universe — past, present, and future — occurs according to the knowledge, will, and command of Allah.

Allah is not unaware of what happens. He knows every detail — from the motion of the stars to the thoughts of a human heart. Belief in Qadar means trusting that Allah’s plan is perfect, even when we cannot see the wisdom behind it.

Muslims believe in four key aspects of Divine Decree:

1. Allah’s Knowledge (‘Ilm): Allah knows everything — what has happened, what is happening, and what will happen.
2. Allah’s Writing (Kitābah): Everything is recorded in the Preserved Tablet (al-Lawḥ al-Maḥfūz).
3. Allah’s Will (Mashī’ah): Nothing occurs without His permission and will.
4. Allah’s Creation (Khalq): Allah is the Creator of all things, including human actions.

Why belief in Qadar matters

Believing in Divine Decree helps people understand that:

1. Life is not chaotic: There is divine order and purpose behind every event.
2. Human effort still matters: We are responsible for our choices, even though Allah knows their outcomes.
3. Peace of mind: Trusting Allah’s plan brings calm during success or failure.
4. Accountability: Since humans act with free will within Allah’s knowledge, they are answerable for their decisions.

This belief gives balance — it prevents arrogance in success and despair in hardship.

What Qadar means (in simple terms)

Concept	Explanation	Everyday Analogy
Divine Knowledge	Allah knows all things perfectly	Like a teacher who knows which students will pass or fail — but the students still take the test freely
Recording	All events are written in the divine record	Like a perfect, secure database that stores every detail without error
Divine Will	Nothing happens without Allah's permission	Like an architect approving every part of a building's design
Creation	Allah created all beings and their capacities	Like a programmer who designed a system but lets users make their own choices

Qadar and human free will

Some people think belief in destiny means humans have no choice — but that's a misunderstanding.

Islam teaches a balance between Allah's divine control and human free will:

- Allah knows what choices humans will make.
- But humans still make those choices freely within the limits of their life and circumstances.
- Therefore, Allah's knowledge does not force people — it only reflects His perfect awareness.

Example:

You may know your friend's habits so well that you can predict what they'll eat at dinner — your knowledge doesn't force them to make that choice.

In the same way, Allah's knowledge is absolute but does not remove human responsibility.

How belief in Qadar makes sense (logical explanation)

- The universe runs in harmony — seasons, gravity, growth — all follow laws. This shows order, not randomness.
- If there is divine order in nature, there must also be divine order in human life.
- Accepting Qadar means acknowledging that Allah is the ultimate Planner, beyond human comprehension.
- It does not deny reason or effort; it adds purpose to both.

Qadar and human life — a continuous link

- In success: We thank Allah, knowing He granted the opportunity.
- In failure: We remain patient, knowing there is hidden wisdom.
- In hardship: We trust that Allah's plan includes eventual ease.
- In prayer: We seek Allah's help because He can change our situation within His will.

The difference between fatalism and Qadar

Concept	Fatalism	Qadar (Islamic view)
Human effort	Useless — everything is fixed	Necessary — effort is part of destiny
God's wisdom	Random or absent	Perfect and purposeful
Emotional effect	Leads to hopelessness	Leads to peace and balance
Responsibility	None	Full accountability for choices

Islamic Qadar encourages action with trust in Allah, not passivity.

Why this belief helps daily life

1. Peace: Accepting Allah's plan reduces stress and anxiety.
2. Gratitude: Success becomes a reason to thank Allah, not boast.
3. Patience: Hardship becomes easier when you trust divine wisdom.
4. Humility: Realizing Allah controls outcomes removes arrogance.
5. Motivation: Knowing that effort is rewarded gives purpose to every struggle.

A real-life way to understand this belief

Imagine a navigator app on your phone:

- The developer designed the map (Allah's knowledge and plan).
- You choose the route (your free will).
- If you make a wrong turn, the app recalculates (Allah's mercy and wisdom).
- You still reach your destination if you follow the guidance.

That is how Qadar works — Allah has the master plan, but you still steer your own path within it.

What Qadar teaches us about ourselves

- We are limited beings within a perfect divine system.
- Life's tests and changes are opportunities for faith and growth.
- True peace comes from trusting Allah's wisdom, not controlling every detail.
- Balance between effort and trust is the key to spiritual maturity.

Summary

- Qadar means Allah's knowledge, will, and control over all things.

- It does not cancel human free will but aligns it with divine purpose.
- Belief in Qadar builds patience, humility, gratitude, and peace.
- Everything happens by Allah's wisdom, even when we cannot understand it.
- This belief teaches balance — work hard, trust Allah, and accept His decree with peace.

Study Guide & Discussion Section

This section is designed to help readers **reflect, internalize, and apply** the beliefs explained in the booklet.

Faith (*Īmān*) grows stronger when it is understood deeply and discussed sincerely.

You can use these questions for:

- **Personal reflection** after reading each chapter.
- **Group discussion** in classes or study circles.
- **Mentorship sessions** for new Muslims or learners.

1. Belief in the Oneness of God (Tawḥīd)

Key Idea: There is only one true God — the Creator, Sustainer, and Ruler of all existence.

He has no partners, equals, or rivals.

Reflect & Discuss:

- What does “Oneness of God” mean beyond just believing in one deity?
- How does understanding Tawḥīd affect daily life and decision-making?
- Can you find examples in nature or science that reflect God’s unity and design?
- Why is associating partners with God (shirk) considered the greatest error in Islam?

Action Point:

Spend a few minutes observing your surroundings. How does each part of creation point to one perfect Designer?

2. Belief in the Angels (al-Malā'ikah)

Key Idea: Angels are real creations of light, who obey God perfectly and carry out His commands.

Reflect & Discuss:

- How does believing in angels change the way we see accountability and protection in life?
- Why is it important to know that angels never disobey God?
- How might awareness of the recording angels affect one's behavior?

Action Point:

Before sleeping, reflect on your day as if you're reviewing it with the angels who recorded it — what would you want to be written on your “right-hand” page?

3. Belief in the Divine Books (Kutub)

Key Idea: God revealed guidance to humanity through sacred books — culminating in the Qur'an, the final and preserved revelation.

Reflect & Discuss:

- What does it mean that the Qur'an confirms the truth of earlier scriptures?
- How does the preservation of the Qur'an strengthen faith in its divine origin?
- Why is it important to study and understand the Qur'an personally, not just recite it?

Action Point:

Read a short passage from the Qur'an with translation and reflect on how it speaks to your present life.

4. Belief in the Prophets (Nubuwwah)

Key Idea: Prophets were chosen by God to guide humanity with truth, wisdom, and moral example.

Reflect & Discuss:

- Why did God send different prophets to different nations?
- What lessons can we learn from the lives of Prophets like Noah, Abraham, Moses, Jesus, and Muhammad (peace be upon them all)?
- How does following the Prophet Muhammad's teachings help us live balanced and ethical lives?

Action Point:

Choose one Prophet's story this week — read it, and write one timeless lesson you can apply today.

5. Belief in the Last Day (Ākhirah)

Key Idea: Life does not end at death; every soul will be resurrected and judged with perfect justice.

Reflect & Discuss:

- How does belief in the Hereafter affect your choices and priorities?
- Why is divine justice only complete when there is life after death?
- How can this belief bring peace during times of loss or injustice?

Action Point:

Reflect each evening: *If today were my last day, what would I want to improve tomorrow?*

6. Belief in Divine Decree (Qadar)

Key Idea: Everything happens according to God’s knowledge, will, and wisdom — yet humans are responsible for their choices.

Reflect & Discuss:

- How can belief in Qadar help reduce anxiety and regret?
- What is the difference between trusting God and being careless about effort?
- How can this belief help someone stay hopeful during hardship?

Action Point:

When facing a difficulty, remind yourself: *“This is written for me, not against me — I will face it with faith and patience.”*

Final Reflection

- Which belief strengthened your understanding of Islam the most?
- How do all six beliefs connect together as one unified system of truth?
- What practical changes do you plan to make in your life after understanding these Aqāid?

Suggested Method for Teachers or Study Circles

- Begin each session with a short recitation or reflection.
- Read one chapter aloud, then discuss the reflection questions.
- Encourage learners to write personal notes or insights.
- Conclude each session with a short supplication (*du‘ā`*) for understanding and steadfastness in faith.

Conclusion: The Harmony of Faith

Faith (*Īmān*) in Islam is not a collection of separate ideas — it is a **complete system of understanding** that connects the human being to the Creator, to the universe, and to the purpose of existence. When the six pillars of faith are understood together, they form a picture of **divine harmony**, where everything — from the smallest atom to the human heart — follows a perfect balance designed by God.

1. The Unity Behind All Beliefs

At the core of every belief lies the truth of **Tawḥīd** — **the Oneness of God**.

Every other Aqīdah flows from this single source:

- **Angels** reflect His perfect order and obedience.
- **Divine Books** convey His eternal message.
- **Prophets** represent His mercy and guidance in human form.
- **The Hereafter** fulfills His justice and wisdom.
- **Divine Decree (Qadar)** expresses His knowledge and control over all things.

Together, these beliefs do not compete — they **complement and complete one another**.

They show that the universe is not random, and human life is not meaningless.

Everything — seen and unseen — is part of a single divine plan, held together by the will of One Creator.

2. Faith as Balance Between Mind and Heart

Islamic belief is not blind emotion, nor is it cold philosophy.

It is a **balance between reason and revelation, intellect and inspiration**.

The Qur'an invites believers to "*think, reflect, and understand*," but it

also reminds them that true understanding begins when the heart is humble before the truth.

This harmony between mind and heart gives faith its strength.

A believer does not reject reason, but uses it to recognize the signs of God.

Nor does he rely only on emotion — he grounds his feelings in clear, truthful knowledge.

Faith, then, is not merely a statement of the tongue, but a **living relationship** between the heart, mind, and soul.

3. Faith as a Source of Peace

When belief is sound, peace follows naturally.

A person who truly understands the Aqāid lives with **inner calm and outer confidence**, because they know:

- There is one God who cares, hears, and provides.
- Life is guided by unseen forces of good, not chaos.
- Revelation is available to guide, not confuse.
- Prophets have shown the way through real human examples.
- Death is not the end, but a doorway to eternal justice.
- Every event, good or bad, has meaning within God's decree.

Such a person can face hardship with patience, success with gratitude, and uncertainty with trust.

This is the **peace (Salām)** that Islam promises — not the absence of challenge, but the presence of purpose.

4. Faith as a Foundation for Character

Belief is not complete until it transforms behavior.

When a person's Aqāid are strong, their actions naturally reflect goodness, honesty, and humility.

- Tawhīd teaches **sincerity**, because worship belongs only to God.

- Belief in angels encourages **accountability**.
- Belief in revelation inspires **truthfulness**.
- Belief in prophets nurtures **compassion and justice**.
- Belief in the Hereafter promotes **responsibility**.
- Belief in Qadar develops **patience and contentment**.

Thus, Aqāid are not abstract ideas — they are **the roots of ethical living**.

Just as a tree draws nourishment from its roots, every good deed grows from sound belief.

5. The Journey of Strengthening Faith

Faith is not static; it grows with knowledge, reflection, and experience. Even the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) would pray:

“O Allah, make my heart firm upon Your religion.”

Every believer, therefore, is on a journey — from knowing, to understanding, to living their faith.

Each stage of life presents new opportunities to deepen belief: through learning, prayer, service, and gratitude.

6. A Universal Message

The Aqāid of Islam are not for one nation or culture — they are **universal truths**.

They speak to the scientist seeking order, the philosopher searching for meaning, and the ordinary person yearning for peace.

They reveal a universe where everything — from the movement of stars to the beating of a heart — follows the same divine command:

*“To God belongs all that is in the heavens and the earth.”
(Qur’an 2:284)*

Islam invites every person to see this harmony, to understand it, and to live in tune with it.

That harmony is not just belief — it is **faith in action, peace in purpose, and light in the soul.**

Final Reflection

When these six beliefs settle firmly in the heart, they create a worldview where:

- **Reason finds clarity,**
- **Heart finds peace,**
- **Life finds direction, and**
- **The soul finds its Creator.**

This is the **Harmony of Faith** — the beautiful rhythm of knowledge, worship, and purpose that Islam offers to every sincere seeker of truth.

Epilogue — A Prayer for Firm Faith

Faith is the light that gives meaning to every moment of life.
It begins as a thought, grows into conviction, and blossoms into peace.
The journey through *Aqāid* is not just about learning — it is about **awakening the soul** to truth, love, and purpose.

As we close this booklet, let us turn our hearts to the One who guided us to seek and understand:

Du‘ā (Supplication)

In the Name of Allah, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate.

O Allah,
You are the Source of all truth, the Light of the heavens and the earth.
You created us, guided us, and opened our hearts to faith.

Grant us understanding that is clear,
hearts that are humble,
and tongues that speak only truth.

O Allah,
Strengthen our belief in You,
in Your angels,
in Your revealed books,
in Your noble messengers,
in the Last Day,
and in Your perfect decree.

Let our faith be firm in doubt,
bright in darkness,
and alive in every moment of our lives.

O Lord,
Make us people of sincerity, gratitude, and patience.
Let our actions reflect the purity of our beliefs.

Keep us among those whose faith grows with knowledge,
whose hearts soften with remembrance,
and whose lives shine with goodness.

Forgive us our shortcomings,
guide us to what pleases You,
and unite us with those who believed and did good —
in everlasting peace, near Your mercy and light.

Āmīn.

LIGHT OF FAITH

نور الإيمان

The Foundations of Islamic Belief

This guide to Islamic beliefs offers a clear and concise explanation of the fundamental aspects of Aqā'id, or the creed of Islam, Through this concise study, readers will gain a deeper understanding of the six pillars of faith and how they shape the lives of Muslims.

Dr. Munib Siddiqui